

RetailzPOS vs. KORONA POS: Which POS System Is Right for Your Store in 2026?

Meta description: A side-by-side comparison of RetailzPOS and KORONA POS for liquor, convenience, and smoke/vape retailers — pricing, age verification, loyalty, inventory, and what to actually ask before switching. **Target keywords:** RetailzPOS vs KORONA POS, KORONA POS alternative, KORONA POS for liquor stores, KORONA POS for smoke shops **Funnel stage:** Decision (bottom-funnel, comparison-shopping intent) **Author:** RetailzPOS Product Team

Quick answer: RetailzPOS and KORONA POS are both inventory-heavy systems built for specialty retail, but they're aimed at different shelves. KORONA POS serves a wide range of specialty categories — liquor, convenience, vape, wineries, gift shops, ticketed venues — with published, tiered pricing starting at \$59–\$69/month plus add-ons, and a loyalty program built directly into the POS. RetailzPOS stays narrowly focused on liquor, convenience, smoke/vape, and CBD retail specifically, pairs with Moolah Points (a dedicated loyalty product built around alcohol/tobacco marketing-compliance rules like SHAFT and TCPA), and prices by custom quote rather than publishing tiers. Both vendors describe their age-verification prompts as blocking checkout until a customer is confirmed of legal age, rather than a reminder a cashier can dismiss. If published, predictable pricing matters most to you, that's a real KORONA advantage. If deep, vertical-specific compliance marketing matters more, that's where RetailzPOS is built differently — and it's worth testing both claims with a live demo before deciding.

RetailzPOS vs. KORONA POS at a glance

Choose RetailzPOS if you want a system built exclusively around age-restricted, regulated retail (liquor, smoke/vape, CBD), compliance-aware SMS/email marketing through Moolah Points, AI-driven reorder alerts, and multi-store support designed for that specific category set.

Choose KORONA POS if you want published, predictable pricing you can budget against without a sales call, a system that also fits categories outside age-restricted retail (wineries, gift shops, ticketed venues), and a loyalty feature bundled directly into the POS instead of a separate product.

Both are legitimate, inventory-first systems — the real fork is how narrow or broad your retail footprint is, and how much you want pricing transparency versus a custom-fit quote.

Why this comparison matters

KORONA POS has quietly built one of the more sophisticated content and SEO operations in the specialty-retail POS category — if you’ve searched for liquor, convenience, or smoke-shop POS software at all, you’ve likely run into their content. It’s also one of the few competitors in this space that publishes real pricing instead of gating it behind a demo call, which makes it a natural first comparison for an owner trying to budget before talking to anyone. This page exists because, until now, there hasn’t been a direct, honest head-to-head between KORONA and RetailzPOS anywhere — including on our own site.

Expanded comparison

	RetailzPOS	KORONA POS
Built for	Liquor, convenience, smoke/vape, and CBD retail specifically	Broad specialty retail: liquor, convenience, vape, wineries, gift shops, ticketed venues
Pricing	Custom quote — not published	Published: Core plan \$59/month, Retail plan \$69/month, add-ons (Food, Plus, Invoicing) \$10–\$45/month per terminal
Inventory management	Case-to-bottle conversion, real-time stock, AI reorder alerts	Deep inventory-management tooling, positioned as a core strength across all supported verticals
Age verification	Hard-block enforcement at checkout with automatic audit logging	Automatic prompt tied to restricted SKUs, blocking checkout until verified — KORONA’s own documentation describes both automatic and manual verification modes
Loyalty program	Via Moolah Points — a dedicated product with vertical-specific mechanics and compliance-aware SMS/email	Built directly into the POS — purchase tracking, personalized discounts, and SMS marketing available without a separate platform

	RetailzPOS	KORONA POS
Payment processing	Dual pricing (cash/card), flexible processing	Processing-agnostic — works with most major processors, no required in-house processor
Multi-store support	Built for growth across multiple locations with unified inventory/reporting	Confirm current multi-location reporting specifics directly with vendor
Hardware	Confirm current hardware options directly with vendor	Stationary terminals, mobile/tablet setups, and self-checkout kiosks, with customizable screen layouts
Compliance-specific marketing content	SMS/email built with SHAFT, TCPA, and DISCUS guidance in mind for alcohol/tobacco retail specifically	Confirm current compliance-specific marketing guardrails directly with vendor
Support & onboarding	Dedicated onboarding support	Confirm current support hours/SLA directly with vendor

(Several rows above are marked “confirm directly with vendor” — KORONA doesn’t publish granular detail on every feature, so it’s more useful to tell you exactly what to ask than to guess. KORONA’s pricing is published and current as of this writing; always verify the live number before budgeting, since software pricing changes.)

Where they actually differ

Breadth vs. depth. This is the real difference, more than any single feature. KORONA POS is built to serve specialty retail broadly — a winery, a gift shop, and a liquor store can all run on it. RetailzPOS made the opposite bet: stay narrowly inside liquor, convenience, smoke/vape, and CBD retail, and go deeper on the specific compliance and marketing problems that category set actually has. Neither approach is wrong — a multi-category specialty retailer may be better served by KORONA’s breadth, while a store that’s exclusively liquor, smoke/vape, or CBD may get more out of a system built around nothing else.

Pricing transparency. KORONA publishes real numbers — Core at \$59/month, Retail at \$69/month, with clearly listed add-on pricing. RetailzPOS, like most vendors in this specific niche (see our [Bottle POS comparison](#)), prices by custom quote instead. If you want to budget before ever talking to sales, that’s a genuine point in KORONA’s favor — worth naming plainly rather than glossing over.

Age verification. Both vendors describe the same core mechanism: a prompt tied to a restricted SKU that blocks the sale until verification happens, not a dismissible reminder.

The real question isn't which vendor claims hard-block enforcement — both do — it's which implementation actually resists a rushed cashier clicking through it on a busy Friday night. Ask both vendors for a live demo of exactly what that screen looks like, not just a feature-sheet claim.

Loyalty: bundled vs. purpose-built. The same fork in the road as our Bottle POS comparison, for a similar reason. KORONA's loyalty program lives inside the POS itself — purchase tracking, discounts, and SMS from one system, no separate product to manage. Moolah Points is a dedicated product paired to RetailzPOS, built specifically around alcohol/tobacco marketing-compliance content rules ([SHAFT](#), [TCPA](#), [DISCUS](#)) rather than general-purpose SMS marketing. If your loyalty marketing needs to navigate what you can and can't legally text a customer about alcohol or tobacco, ask both vendors specifically how their SMS tooling handles that — don't assume a general-purpose loyalty feature already accounts for it.

Switching from KORONA POS to RetailzPOS: what to expect

- **Inventory import.** Your SKU list, case/bottle configurations, and current stock counts should transfer as part of onboarding — confirm the specific export format KORONA provides and how it maps into RetailzPOS before your switch date.
- **Customer and loyalty data migration.** If you're bringing loyalty balances or customer records over from KORONA's built-in program, ask how that data maps into Moolah Points' reward structure, since the two loyalty models aren't identical.
- **Training.** Staff familiar with KORONA's interface will need time on RetailzPOS's — ask what onboarding support is included and plan a short overlap period rather than a hard cutover.
- **Downtime.** Any POS migration carries some cutover risk. Ask for a specific go-live plan, including a fallback if data doesn't transfer cleanly.

None of this is a reason to avoid switching if RetailzPOS is genuinely the better fit for your category — it's a reason to get a specific migration plan before committing to a date.

Illustrative example: a multi-category specialty retailer narrowing focus

The following is a composite, illustrative scenario built from common patterns in specialty retail — not a specific named customer case study.

Picture a store that started as a general gift-and-specialty shop and has, over a few years, shifted to carry mostly beer, wine, and spirits as that category became the real

revenue driver. The POS system handling check-out still treats a bottle of bourbon the same way it treats a candle or a greeting card — inventory works, but nothing about the system is built around the specific problems of selling alcohol: no compliance-aware SMS marketing, no case-to-bottle conversion logic, no audit trail built specifically around age-verification incidents. As the store’s product mix keeps narrowing toward liquor, the owner starts wondering whether a broad specialty-retail system is still the right fit, or whether a system built exclusively around what the store has actually become would serve it better.

A category-specific system like RetailzPOS doesn’t make that store’s inventory “more correct” — it makes the compliance and marketing tooling match what the store actually sells now, instead of what it sold when the POS was first chosen.

Buyer checklist

Print this or copy it into your notes before your next vendor call — for either system:

☐

Is the published pricing (if any) the final price, or are there per-terminal, per-location, or processing fees layered on top?

☐

Is age verification hard-blocked (transaction can’t complete without a check), and can you see a live demo of what a cashier actually sees?

☐

Does the loyalty/SMS tooling account for alcohol- or tobacco-specific marketing content restrictions (SHAFT, TCPA, DISCUS), or is that on you to figure out?

☐

How does case-to-single-unit inventory conversion work when a case is broken mid-shift?

☐

Does the system support your actual category mix today, or is it built around a broader set of verticals than you need?

☐

What payment processing options are available, and are you locked into one processor?

☐

What does data portability look like if you switch systems again later?

☐

What training and onboarding support is included, and for how long after go-live?

A note on how to read this comparison

This comparison is meant to help you ask sharper questions of both vendors — not to declare a universal winner. KORONA POS is a legitimate, well-built specialty-retail system with real published pricing and a broad category fit; RetailzPOS is built around a narrower bet, that liquor, convenience, smoke/vape, and CBD retail deserve deeper, purpose-built compliance and marketing tools than a general specialty-retail system provides. Different stores, at different stages and with different category mixes, will reasonably land on different answers. Verify current features and pricing directly with both vendors before deciding — this space moves fast, and any comparison, including this one, is a snapshot, not a permanent record.

Bottom line

If predictable, published pricing and broad specialty-category support matter most, KORONA POS is a reasonable, well-established choice. If your store is specifically liquor, convenience, smoke/vape, or CBD retail, and compliance-aware loyalty marketing is meant to be a real growth channel rather than a bundled afterthought, RetailzPOS paired with Moolah Points is built for that specifically.

Ready to see what fits your store's actual category mix? [Schedule a personalized demo] built around how your store operates — or [check current pricing] for your specific terminal count and location.

FAQ

Is KORONA POS or RetailzPOS better for a liquor store specifically? Both serve liquor retail. KORONA offers published pricing and also fits stores with a broader category mix (wineries, gift items). RetailzPOS is built exclusively around liquor, convenience, smoke/vape, and CBD retail, with Moolah Points as a dedicated, compliance-aware loyalty layer.

Does KORONA POS publish its pricing? Yes — KORONA lists a Core plan at \$59/month and a Retail plan at \$69/month, with add-ons like Food, Plus, and Invoicing ranging from \$10–\$45/month per terminal. RetailzPOS prices by custom quote instead; confirm current numbers directly with each vendor, since pricing changes.

Does KORONA POS block a sale if age verification fails? KORONA's own documentation describes an automatic prompt tied to restricted SKUs that blocks checkout until verification happens, with both automatic and manual modes available. Ask for a live demo from both vendors to see exactly how the cashier-facing screen behaves under a busy, rushed checkout.

Can I run SMS marketing campaigns through either platform? KORONA includes SMS marketing as part of its bundled loyalty program. RetailzPOS's loyalty layer (Moolah Points) is built with alcohol/tobacco marketing-compliance content rules (SHAFT, TCPA, DISCUS) in mind specifically. Ask both vendors how their SMS tooling handles age-restricted product marketing before assuming either has it fully solved.

What's involved in switching from KORONA POS to RetailzPOS? Inventory import, customer/loyalty data migration, staff training, and a planned go-live cutover. Ask for a specific migration plan — including how loyalty balances transfer — before committing to a switch date.

Is this comparison biased since RetailzPOS wrote it? Fair question — we're transparent that this comes from the RetailzPOS Product Team, and it's written to help you ask sharper questions of both vendors, not to hide KORONA's legitimate strengths, including its pricing transparency. Verify anything that matters to your decision directly with both companies.

Sources

- [KORONA POS — Age Verification documentation](#)
- [KORONA POS — KORONA POS vs. Bottle POS](#)
- [BMC POS — KORONA POS Review \(2026\): Features, Pricing, and Fit](#)
- [PosNation — Bottle POS vs. KORONA POS](#)
- [FCC — Telephone Consumer Protection Act \(TCPA\) rules and orders](#)
- [CTIA — Messaging Principles and Best Practices \(PDF, source of SHAFT content restrictions\)](#)
- [DISCUS — Code of Responsible Practices for Beverage Alcohol Advertising and Marketing](#)

This comparison is based on publicly available product positioning and pricing as of October 2026. Feature sets and pricing change — confirm current details directly with each vendor before deciding.

About the author: Written by the RetailzPOS Product Team, drawing on direct experience working with liquor stores, smoke shops, and convenience retailers on inventory, compliance, and loyalty workflows.

Appendix — structured data for publishing (FAQPage + Organization)

For the dev/publishing team: paste this JSON-LD into the page `<head>` when this post goes live. The FAQ entries mirror the FAQ section above verbatim — keep them in sync if the copy changes.

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Note: the *sameAs* URLs above are placeholders following RetailzPOS's standard profile-link pattern — confirm and swap in the exact live URLs for each review-site profile before publishing.